LEDGER · 2026-08-28 · AGRICULTURAL MICROBIOLOGY

ACC-Deaminase-Secreting Desert Streptomyces via Solid-State Fermentation

REJECTED

This concept did **not** clear the framework.

The reasoning is published in full below.

What the assessment found

Incumbent benchmark	Chemical Anti-Transpirants (e.g., Vapor-Gard) / Generic PGPR (Bacillus subtilis)
Measured advantage	Claims 35% yield rescue in tomato under drought, but the cited study compared against an untreated negative control rather than the named incumbent anti-transpirants or PGPR.
Time to first revenue	14 months
Regulatory risk	Moderate — qualification costs reported ($200,000 estimated)

Why it failed

- Negative control used as incumbent

Assessment

The quantitative yield rescue data cited from literature compares the venture's Streptomyces product against an untreated negative drought control rather than a head-to-head comparison against the named incumbents. Under strict scoring rules, this fails the superiority criterion.

A rejection is not a claim that the science is wrong. It means the venture case did not survive: the comparator was not what the buyer actually buys, the comparison was not like-for-like, the advantage fell short of a step change, or the capital and time to first revenue were prohibitive.

Assessed 2026-08-28 against seven gates plus the voiding sub-tests. How the method works · Browse all concepts